Harriet Dart Reaches Her First Big Final

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British tennis player Harriet Dart has reached her first **WTA Tour singles** final. She beat Sun Xinran of China in three sets at the Guangzhou Open. Dart said reaching the final 'means the world' to her.

Dart is the British number five. This was only her second tour-level **singles semi-final**. She first played on the **WTA Tour** in Eastbourne in 2015. 'It's been a really long journey,' she said. 'I've wanted it so much.'

The match was like a rollercoaster. Dart lost the first set after leading 5-4. Sun, who is 16 and the US Open junior champion, took her chance. Dart won the second set in a **tie-break**, 7-1. In the last set, Sun needed treatment on her left leg, and Dart won every game.

On Sunday, Dart plays fourth **seed** Lilli Tagger in the final. Tagger is ranked 53rd. If Dart wins, she will return to the top 100. She has already climbed 14 places to 101st.

Word Treasure

WTA Tour -- The WTA Tour is the series of top tennis tournaments that Dart plays in.

singles -- Singles is a tennis match with one player on each side.

semi-final -- A semi-final is the match before the final, and the winner goes through to the final.

tie-break -- A tie-break is a short deciding game used to win a set when the score is tied.

seed -- A seed is a top player given a special place in a tournament because of their ranking.

Background you need

A tennis tournament is a contest where players win matches to reach a final, and the winner of the final takes the title.

The WTA Tour is the top series of women's tennis tournaments, where players also earn places in the world rankings.

Harriet Dart first played on the WTA Tour in 2015, so reaching a final has taken her many years of trying.

Break it down

WHO: Harriet Dart, a British tennis player, and her semi-final opponent Sun Xinran of China.
WHAT: Dart won her semi-final in three sets to reach her first WTA Tour singles final.
WHERE: At the Guangzhou Open.
WHY: Dart had wanted this for a long time, saying she first played on the WTA Tour in 2015 and that it has been a really long journey.

Why it matters

It shows children that sticking with a goal for many years can pay off, even when progress is slow.

Test what you remember

1. Who did Harriet Dart beat to reach the final?

(A) Sun Xinran
(B) The fourth seed
(C) Lilli Tagger
(D) A player in Eastbourne

2. At which tournament did Dart win her semi-final?

(A) The US Open
(B) Eastbourne
(C) The Guangzhou Open
(D) Wimbledon

3. How did Dart win the second set?

(A) In a tie-break, 7-1
(B) After Sun had treatment on her leg
(C) She won every game in it
(D) By leading 5-4

4. How old is Sun Xinran?

(A) 16
(B) 53
(C) 14
(D) 101

5. Who does Dart play in the final on Sunday?

(A) The British number five
(B) Harriet Dart
(C) Sun Xinran
(D) Lilli Tagger

6. What will happen if Dart wins the final?

(A) She will return to the top 100
(B) She will be ranked 53rd
(C) She will play in Eastbourne
(D) She will climb 14 places to 101st

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: C 3: A 4: A 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Harriet Dart: She said reaching the final means the world to her and that she has wanted it so much after a really long journey.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):